

Philipp Hilbert. *Principal Product Manager, GCC Growth.*

Positioning, fintech PM with 13 years in regulated industries who ships working prototypes, not decks, and has already built a payments product taken to acquisition.

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§ WHY REMITLY

Remitly's GCC charter is a genuine product problem, not a campaign management exercise: migrant and expatriate senders in Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Qatar, and the wider Gulf carry real trust deficits with incumbent providers, and winning them requires more than a lower FX margin. The posting's explicit call for someone who can prototype their own ideas, run a high-velocity experimentation engine, and navigate KYC/AML and payout-rail complexity in parallel is exactly the kind of multi-dimensional challenge I have sought out across fintech, defence AI, and public-sector analytics. The detail about using AI tools to compress the loop from idea to validated learning, not as a talking point but as a measurable expectation, signals a product culture that values craft over credential. *That is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, pair-programming across Python and Kotlin
- **Cursor / VS Code**, LLM-assisted development environment
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy interactive prototypes
- **GPT**, customer research synthesis and edge-case generation

- **n8n**, agentic workflow orchestration
 - **Gamma.app**, stakeholder-facing strategy decks
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins CI/CD, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, REST APIs, Dagster, dbt, SQL, all in production delivery contexts across defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance SaaS, and payments platforms.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Zero-to-one two-sided B2B marketplace, built and operated solo using LLM agents across the entire funnel.

- Anonymity-until-payment model that protects both matching sides until genuine commitment, removing the headhunter from the construction-staffing hire.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface; LLM agents handling qualification, routing, and follow-up so one person runs day-to-day operations.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; full discovery, design, build, and iteration cycle owned end-to-end.
 - Demonstrates the builder's capability Remitly requires: prototyping, agentic automation, and growth-loop thinking applied to a regulated, trust-sensitive two-sided market.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT REMITLY

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow regional business, compliance, and customer-success conversations in the GCC to build a ground-truth map of where senders drop off, distrust the product, or choose a competitor, before touching the roadmap.

WEEK 2

Instrument, then hypothesise.

Audit the existing experimentation and analytics setup with the data and engineering teams, identify which acquisition and activation drop-off points are measurable today versus which need new instrumentation, and draft the first three testable hypotheses.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, iterate.

Run the first A/B testing cycles on the highest-confidence friction points, establish a weekly experiment-review cadence with engineering, design, and analytics, and begin closing the loop between validated learnings and the OKR-level roadmap.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Remitly Hiring Team,

Remitly's GCC growth charter sits at the intersection of the two things I find most technically interesting in product management: trust-dependent financial services for underserved communities, and the question of how far AI tooling can compress the distance between a customer insight and a shipped, validated feature. I have spent thirteen years at that intersection, most recently building the FCAS AI and data platform at Rohde & Schwarz and running product for a national labour-market analytics platform at the Federal Employment Agency, and I want to bring that experience to a consumer problem that genuinely matters.

The work I am most proud of is the kind the GCC role demands: deciding what to cut rather than what to add. At CLINET Platforms I inherited a roadmap a five-person team could not deliver. I reduced it to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures and user acceptance rose more than fivefold. At Rohde & Schwarz I instrumented two competing product strategies, a UI-led approach and a developer-code-first approach, and the UI-led one recorded exactly zero clicks in production. I redirected the strategy and pipeline runs increased 200%. Those are the kinds of data-informed decisions I would bring to acquisition, activation, and retention work across the Gulf.

On the builder dimension: I prototype my own ideas. My current side project, construct8, is a two-sided B2B marketplace I designed, built, and operate solo, using LLM agents across the qualification and routing funnel, with WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface and funnel analytics in SQL. Earlier in my career I co-founded Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile P2P group payments product built inside the girocard ecosystem and eventually acquired and operated by Sparkasse. I understand KYC/AML constraints, payout-rail mechanics, and FX

tradeoffs not as compliance overhead but as product design constraints that, handled well, become competitive moats. That is the fintech depth the posting asks for.

The GCC-specific context is one I am actively building. The Gulf's migrant and expatriate sender base, the customers Remitly is serving, faces a specific trust equation: speed and affordability matter, but so does payout reliability in the recipient country and confidence that money will arrive before a family payment is due. I have not shipped a product specifically for MENA users, and I would name that honestly as the one gap I am walking in with. What I bring instead is a track record of fast, structured customer discovery, I would treat the first weeks in this role as intensive listening, not strategy-presenting, and a method for turning qualitative empathy into quantitative experimentation that the data and engineering teams can act on.

I am based in Berlin, hold EU citizenship with no visa requirement, and am actively targeting the UAE: I am willing to relocate to Dubai or Abu Dhabi and work fully on-site if that is the right setup for this team. I would welcome the opportunity to talk about the GCC roadmap and what a first quarter of high-velocity experimentation could look like.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Principal Product Manager with 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries, fintech, defence AI, insurance, public-sector analytics, and healthcare, with a track record of product-led growth across acquisition, activation, and retention. Known for cutting roadmaps ruthlessly, running data-informed A/B testing and experimentation engines, and shipping working prototypes rather than decks. EU citizen, no visa requirement, willing to relocate to the UAE.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Growth and experimentation: A/B testing, acquisition and retention loop design, funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, MVP scoping, PoC, continuous discovery, user research and interviews, go-to-market support.

Fintech and payments: P2P payments product design, PSP integration, KYC/AML constraint navigation, FX and payout-rail mechanics, girocard ecosystem, regulated consumer financial services.

AI products and tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); full prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor and Lovable.

Product ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product management: product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, prototyping, product lifecycle management.

Agile and scaled delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning.

Analytics and data: Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, SQL funnel analysis.

Stakeholder and leadership: cross-functional team leadership (15+ engineers and data scientists), C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Technical environments: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins CI/CD, Python, Kotlin, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, REST APIs.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

Insurance: B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers, and underwriters; Claims Center delivery; product-to-market acceleration.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI 2024-2025

GitOps delivery with ArgoCD cut rollout from days to 30 minutes; redirected platform strategy from UI-led to developer-code-first after instrumentation showed zero UI engagement, increasing pipeline runs 200%. Cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists in Scrum (Jira, Confluence).

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Integrated test automation into Jenkins, introduced Dagster and dbt to eliminate manual data imports (75% time saving per update), and migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers while delivering a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2023-2023

Cut an undeliverable roadmap to the top 10% of features; user acceptance rose more than fivefold. Implemented CGM interface into hospital KIS workflows: digital anamnesis time dropped from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022-2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS 2021-2022

Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT DATA 2021-2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE 2019-2020

Migrated a legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and 20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY 2019-2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING 2025-PRESENT

Zero-to-one two-sided B2B marketplace; LLM agents across the funnel; WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface; funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · IT SECURITY 2016-2021

Quantum-secure encryption hardware and software; shipped a three-layer product installable in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · DEEP TECH 2018-2021

Took a nanotechnology fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH 2013-2018

Mobile P2P group payments product built from zero; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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